

Antonio Carmagnani

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Dear Hiring Team at Collen,

I trained as an architect, and the part of the work that stayed with me was never the drawing, it was what a project costs and how the price gets built up. That interest is what pushed me toward feasibility work early on, and later from São Paulo to Copenhagen for an M.Arch in Architecture Computation at The Royal Danish Academy. I should say plainly that I have not held an estimator's title, so the bills of quantities and prelim allowances would be new to me. Tendering itself is not.

At Sweco I worked on competitive international tenders for infrastructure projects. I assembled bid teams, sourcing the specialist consultants needed to evidence local and technical expertise, and wrote technical and methodology sections of the proposals. I also built the pricing tool the team uses to support bid decisions, parametricising expert fee bands and project economics so a bid could be tested for viability before it went out. Alongside that I reviewed engineering designs under FIDIC Yellow Book arrangements, checking specifications against subconsultants' drawings, which is where I learned how much of a bid is really document inspection.

The cost side comes from the development work. At Felipe Hess Architects I ran financial feasibility on residential schemes, testing saleable area, unit mix and development cost against the buildable programme, and produced the BIM documentation and construction drawings alongside it. At OSPA I sized investment and return across more than fifteen feasibility studies for developer clients. Earlier, at Itaú-Unibanco, I reviewed technical documentation from architecture and engineering firms against building, accessibility and fire-safety standards before construction could be authorised. I have also priced and delivered my own client work for years, which teaches the same lesson more directly.

Collen is building out a preconstruction department in Copenhagen with the estimating team in Dublin, and I would be joining to learn the trade properly from people who do it well.

All the best,

Antonio Carmagnani